

Installation

Installing the firewall is not a major concern as it installs along with the default installation of the Service Pack. Also, after installation, the firewall is always turned On by default. It is the configuration of the firewall that we are interested in. Let's take a look at this.

Configuration

To configure the settings of the firewall, we will need to go to the 'Network Connections' in the 'Control Panel'. Here, we will see the Local Area Connection we had created. Right-click on this and click on 'Properties'. Then, click on the 'Advanced' tab and you will get to the firewall interface. You will see that it has changed since the last time. The reason for this is that you enabled the firewall when configuring the LAN connection.



Windows XP SP2 firewall options

In the next window, click 'Settings', and you will get to a new window where you will be able to configure the firewall. You will see that, by default, the firewall is On.

When you click on the 'Exceptions' tab, you will be taken to a window that has some programs listed alphabetically. These are the programs that are being allowed to send and receive data on the Internet. You can customise this list and add any other programs you want by clicking on the 'Add Program' button. For instance, if you play online games, you will want to add the path of the game executable in this list lest the firewall block the game from accessing the Internet. You can also add specific ports and edit a program already added. If you want to remove a program from the list, you can click on the 'Delete' button.